Unit 1 — Identities

Track E · Klasse 8 · Niveau E

Learning objectives I

- *I can read a short identity-text and identify the writer's main claim.*
- *I can use both / either / neither* to talk about belonging.
- *I can write a 120-word self-portrait that goes beyond surface labels.*

Lead-in I

Hawa's class made a wall called *Who Am I, Today?* Each student pinned three small cards to the wall: a country, a language, a thing they like. Hawa pinned *Nigeria, Yoruba, my grandmother's stew*. Jonas pinned *Germany, Polish, my brother's old skateboard*. The wall, by Friday, looked like an unusually honest atlas.

Vocabulary I

- roots
- heritage
- language
- belonging
- hometown
- background
- identity
- multilingual
- bilingual
- first language
- mother tongue
- second language

Vocabulary I

- tradition
- custom
- community

Reading I

Reading — *Hawa's wall*
The wall changed every week. People added new cards, moved old ones, sometimes took one down and never explained why. Mr. Ade said the wall was "a working draft of the class". I think identity is also a working draft. We are who we are right now, plus the things we are still trying out, plus the things we haven't told anyone yet.

Vocabulary — identity
roots, heritage, language, belonging, hometown, background, identity, multilingual, bilingual, first language, mother tongue, second language, tradition, custom, community.

Grammar — *both / either / neither*

Reading II

- *Both* + plural: *Both languages are part of who I am.*
- *Either* + singular (in negatives/questions): *I don't speak either language perfectly.*
- *Neither* + singular: *Neither parent grew up here.*
- *Both … and …*: *I speak both Polish and German at home.*
- *Neither … nor …*: *Neither my mum nor my dad celebrates that holiday.*

Practise I

Niveau E — controlled

1. Choose: *both / either / neither* — Hawa speaks _____ Yoruba and English. I don't speak _____ language perfectly. _____ of my parents was born here.
2. Build: *(both / Polish / German)* → ___ ; *(neither / mum / dad / celebrates)* → ___ .

Niveau E — productive

3. Build 4 sentences about your own languages, places, or traditions using *both / either / neither / both … and …*

Your turn I

Self-portrait, 120 words. Three paragraphs: *Where I come from* (1–2 sentences), *Languages and people in my life* (4–5 sentences), *What I am still figuring out* (2–3 sentences). Use at least two of: *both / either / neither / both … and …*

Sample

I come from Stuttgart, but my parents come from Krakow. I grew up hearing Polish at home and German at school. I speak both languages, although neither of them perfectly. My grandmother sends me long voice messages in a mix of both, and I love it. What I am still figuring out is whether I want to study in Germany or in Poland. Either way, I think I will end up with a strange accent.

Reflect I

- I can read an identity text and find the main claim.
- I can use *both / either / neither / both … and ….*
- I can write a 120-word self-portrait beyond labels.

Further reading / listening I

- BBC Bitesize — *Identity* topic at KS3 level.
- British Council Voices — short student-identity essays.